CHATBOT REVIEW · ZOHO SALESIQ

Zoho's chatbot options, *and why they fall short for us.*

Zoho SalesIQ comes with our CRM Plus plan, so I checked every way it lets us put a chatbot on the website. For each option, the pages ahead show a sample chat: one question it handles well, and one it can't.

PREPARED FOR **DATASPHERE EDU SOLUTIONS** PREPARED BY **VENKATESH BIRADAR** DATE **12 OCT 2026**

WHAT ZOHO OFFERS	WHAT THEY'RE GOOD AT	WHERE THEY FAIL
Three bot types in SalesIQ: a flow builder (Zobot), a FAQ bot (Answer Bot), and Zobot with SalesIQ Scripts.	Collecting a student's details and passing the chat to our team.	Understanding a student's question in their own words and suggesting the right course.

01

What a good chatbot must do for us

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over
Fees, duration, syllabus, batches, online or classroom.	Understands the student's goal and points to the right course.	The team can change a fee or date without a developer.	Name, phone and course reach Zoho CRM.	Offers a call-back when it can't help.

02

How Zoho adds a chatbot to the website

STUDENT
Clicks the chat bubble on our site

→

SALESIQ WIDGET
Chat window, added with one script

→

BOT BRAIN · PICK ONE
1. Zobot (flow)
2. Answer Bot
3. Zobot + Scripts

→

ZOHO CRM PLUS
Lead saved

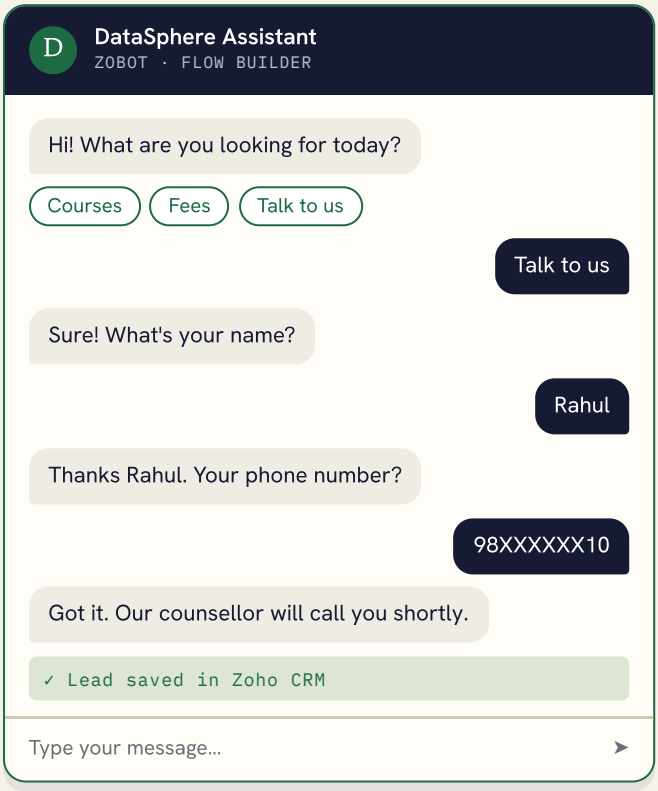
How to read the next pages: FITS works well · PARTLY works with limits or manual effort · DOESN'T FIT can't be relied on. Course names, fees and timings in the chats are sample values; the marks are based on Zoho's SalesIQ documentation and our SalesIQ account.

03 · Option 1

Zobot: the no-code flow builder

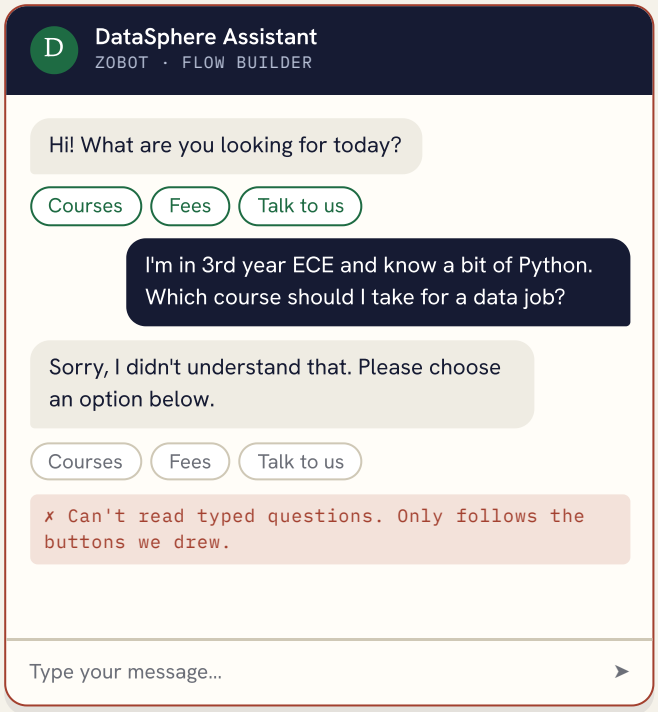
We draw the chat as a flowchart: buttons and questions → The student clicks through the path we drew → Answers are saved to Zoho CRM

WHERE IT WORKS · COLLECTING DETAILS



Button-driven forms work well. The student's details go straight into Zoho CRM.

WHERE IT FAILS · ASKING FOR ADVICE



The moment a student types a real question, the bot can only repeat its menu.

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over
DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	PARTLY	FITS	FITS

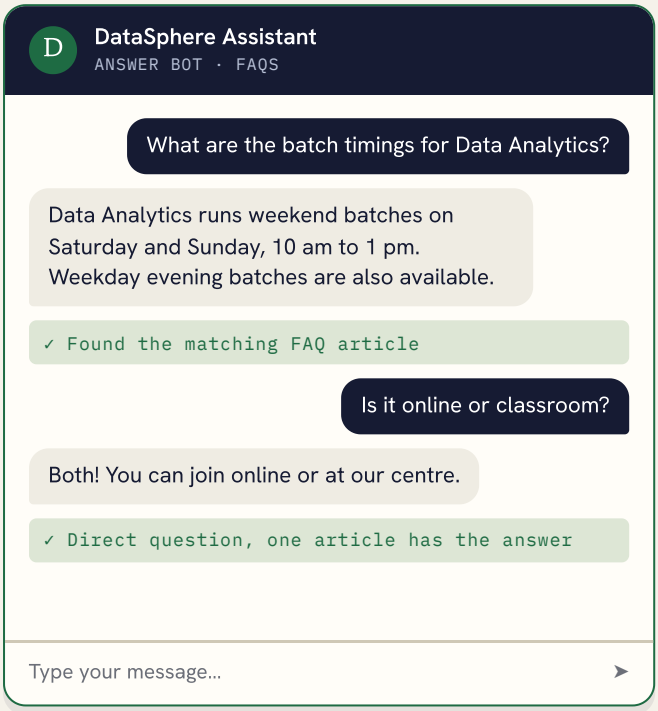
Why we can't use it: it's a form with buttons, not a conversation. To "recommend" courses we'd have to draw a branch for every background, skill and goal, which nobody could maintain.

04 · Option 2

Answer Bot: replies from our FAQs

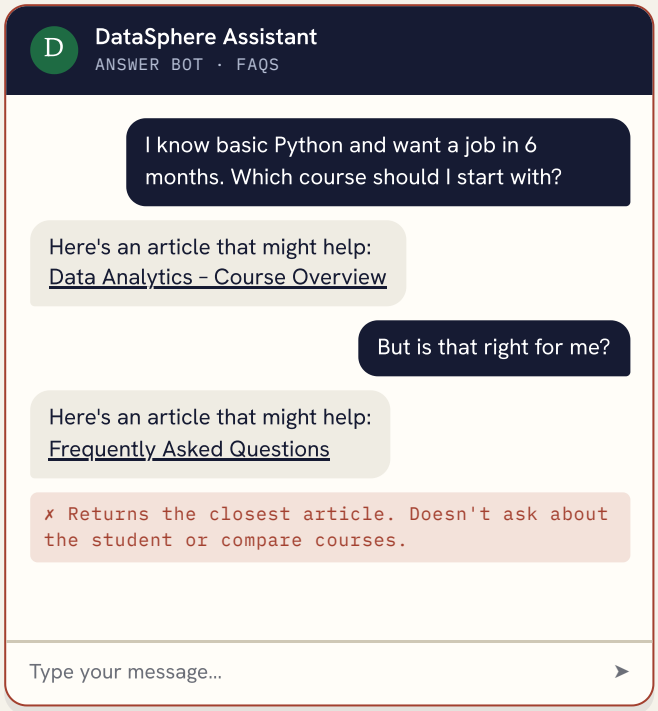
We add FAQs and articles to SalesIQ → The bot finds the closest article → Zoho's AI (Zia) rewords it as a reply

● WHERE IT WORKS · SIMPLE FACTS



Direct questions with a ready answer in one article work fine.

● WHERE IT FAILS · PERSONAL ADVICE



It answers from one article at a time. It can't understand the student and suggest a path.

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over
PARTLY	DOESN'T FIT	PARTLY	PARTLY	FITS

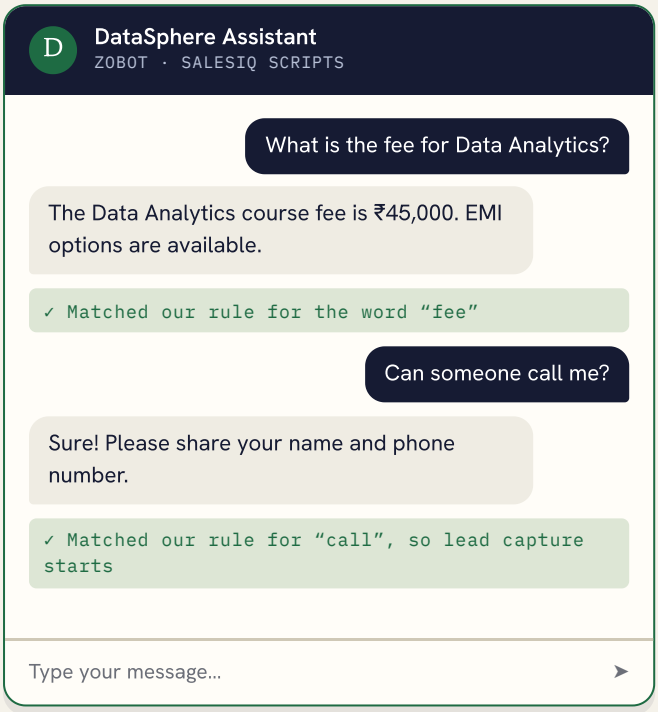
Why we can't use it: it's a search box over FAQs. All course info would have to be rewritten as articles and kept in sync by hand, and it still couldn't suggest courses or collect leads on its own.

05 · Option 3

Zobot with SalesIQ Scripts

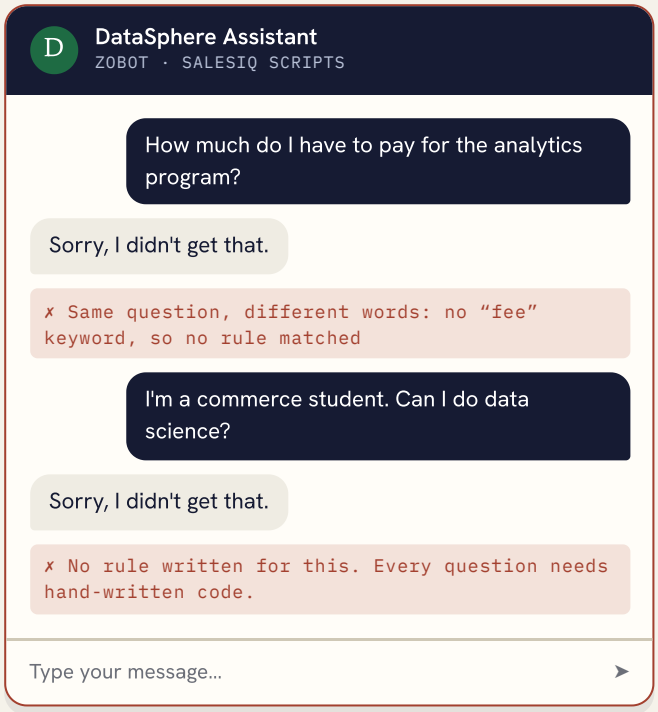
We write rules in Deluge, Zoho's own coding language → Each message is checked against our rules → The matching rule sends its reply

WHERE IT WORKS · EXACT KEYWORDS



Questions that contain the words we coded for get the right answer.

WHERE IT FAILS · REAL STUDENT QUESTIONS



Students don't use our keywords. Anything we didn't predict falls through.

Correct answers	Suggests courses	Easy to update	Saves leads	Hands over
PARTLY	DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	FITS	FITS

Why we can't use it: it isn't AI, just hand-written if/else rules. Every new question or fee change needs someone who knows Deluge, so the team couldn't update it on their own.

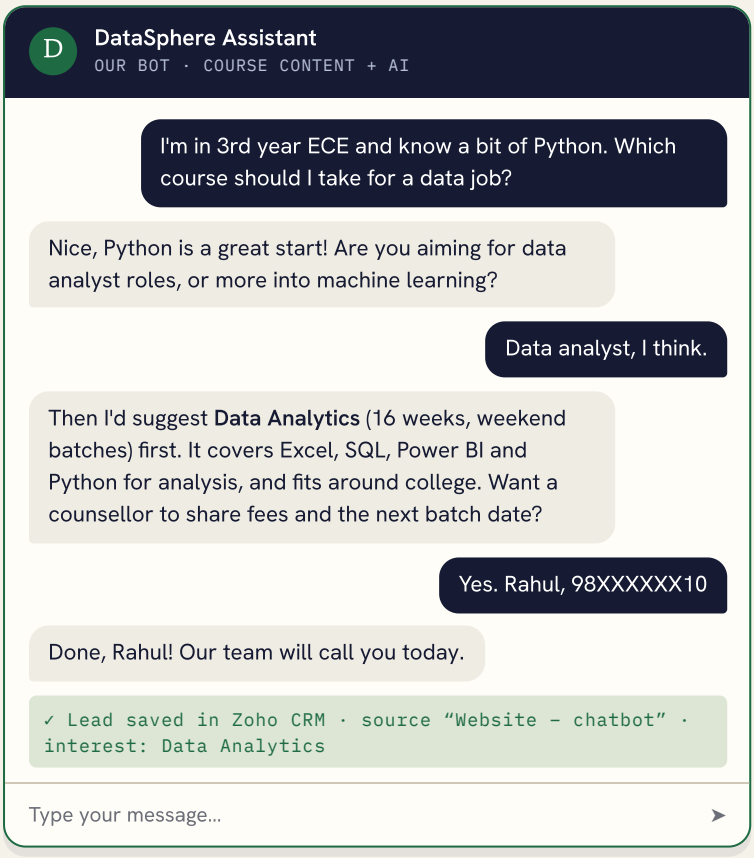
06 · The better option

Our own RAG chatbot, with leads saved in Zoho

Instead of Zoho's bots, we build a chatbot on our own course content (RAG + an AI model). It reads our course details, talks to the student in plain language, suggests the right course, and saves every interested student in **Zoho CRM**, so the team's follow-up stays exactly the same.

Student asks in their own words → **Our bot** looks up our course info (RAG) → **AI** writes the answer and suggests courses → **Zoho CRM** gets the lead automatically

THE SAME QUESTION EVERY ZOHO OPTION FAILED



Correct answers: only from our course info, so it never makes up a fee or date.

Suggests courses: asks a follow-up, then recommends.

Easy to update: the team edits one course sheet; the bot uses it.

Saves leads: name, phone and course go straight to Zoho CRM.

Hands over: offers a call-back whenever it can't help.

NEED	ZOBOT (FLOW)	ANSWER BOT	ZOBOT + SCRIPTS	OUR RAG BOT
Correct answers	DOESN'T FIT	PARTLY	PARTLY	FITS
Suggests courses	DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	DOESN'T FIT	FITS
Easy to update	PARTLY	PARTLY	DOESN'T FIT	FITS
Saves leads	FITS	PARTLY	FITS	FITS
Hands over	FITS	FITS	FITS	FITS